

Taylor Lathrop

CONTACT INFORMATION

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Department of Economics
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DOCTORAL STUDIES

Syracuse University
PhD, Economics, Expected Completion May 2026

DISSERTATION COMMITTEE AND REFERENCES

Alexander Rothenberg (Primary Advisor) Associate Professor of Economics Syracuse University adrothen@syr.edu	John Cawley (Syracuse Placement Officer) Professor of Economics Syracuse University jhcawley@syr.edu
Ryan Monarch Associate Professor of Economics Syracuse University rpmonarc@syr.edu	Shafaat Yar Khan Assistant Professor of Economics Syracuse University skhan78@syr.edu

PRIOR EDUCATION

The University of Texas at San Antonio Master of Arts in Economics	2017-19
Baylor University Bachelor of Science in Economics	2012-16

CITIZENSHIP

United States

FIELDS

Primary Field: Urban Economics
Secondary Fields: Trade

JOB MARKET PAPER

“Foreign Direct Investment and Local Productivity Spillovers: Evidence from Indonesia”

The sign, magnitude, and even existence of total factor productivity (TFP) spillovers resulting from foreign direct investment (FDI) has been the subject of much debate. While there has been much work on the diffusion of TFP spillovers over large areas, relatively little attention has been given to how they function over smaller spatial scales. This is particularly true in a developing country context, where government efforts to attract FDI make local spillovers an especially important policy consideration. In this paper, I identify and quantify local TFP and revenue spillovers using a rich dataset of Indonesian manufacturing firms with highly granular location information. Within clusters of manufacturing employment defined by a watershed segmentation algorithm, I find an elasticity of domestic firm productivity to average

quality of domestic peers of 0.027, and a much smaller elasticity of domestic firm productivity to average quality of foreign peers of 0.005. For foreign-owned firms, I find little evidence of productivity spillovers from peers of either ownership type. I conduct a simple policy simulation that indicates that firms in the urban fringe stand to gain the most from a boost to the productivity of their neighbors.

WORKING PAPERS

“Urban Sprawl and Residential Carbon Emissions: Evidence from Indonesia and the Philippines” (with Yi Jiang, Alexander Rothenberg, and Yao Wang)

This paper uses detailed data from Indonesian cities to study how variation in density within urban areas affects residential carbon emissions. To address simultaneity, we instrument density with soil characteristics, and to address sorting, we control for community averages of observed characteristics. Preliminary results suggest that while density is positively associated with greater residential carbon emissions, this correlation is driven by income sorting. This suggests that policies aiming to control urban sprawl may not be successful in reducing residential carbon emissions.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Intl. Trade Theory and Policy (Syracuse University)	2023-24
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Ryan Monarch	
Introductory Microeconomics (Syracuse University)	2022; 2023
Instructor	
Intro. to Statistics and Econometrics (Syracuse University)	2022
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Yoonseok Lee	
Intermediate Microeconomics (Syracuse University)	2021-22; 2023
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Inge O'Connor	
Introductory Microeconomics (UT San Antonio)	2019-20
Instructor	
Introductory Macroeconomics (UT San Antonio)	2019-20
Instructor	
Mathematical Economics (UT San Antonio)	2018-19
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Fathali Firoozi	

AWARDS

Graduate Fellowship, Syracuse University	2020-21; 2024-25
Graduate Assistantship, Syracuse University	2021-23; 2025

CONFERENCE & SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

Syracuse University Applied Micro Seminar	2025
Syracuse University Trade Breakfast	2024
Syracuse University Labor Group Seminar	2023, 2025

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Stata, Python, R, ArcGIS, QGIS, LaTeX, MS Office

LANGUAGES

English

Last updated: October 2025